Suzane Santos dos Santos

UX Researcher · PhD candidate in Human-Computer Interaction (ICMC-USP, Brazil)

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Summary

HCI researcher with experience planning, conducting and analyzing user studies: surveys, interviews, moderated usability tests, heuristic evaluation and field research, including with underrepresented audiences such as older adults, children with autism and their educators, trans people and riverside communities in the Amazon. In my PhD, I am developing EmoFrame, a digital environment that supports planning HCI evaluations. Co-author of the Best Paper at IHC 2026.

Research experience

PhD researcher · ICMC-USP 2022 – present

EmoFrame: a framework and system that supports HCI evaluation planning · CAPES scholarship

- Planned and analyzed a survey with 60 computing professionals in Brazil to prioritize product features. The most requested were a results dashboard (81.67%), support for multiple methods (71.67%) and automatic reports (66.67%).
- Identified differences by experience level: the results dashboard reached 91.3% among senior professionals, and the instrument library appealed to 73.91% of senior professionals versus 33.33% of beginners. These findings guided design decisions.
- Developing, with a multidisciplinary team, an environment that brings together instruments from Computing, Psychology and Gerontology (SUS, SAM, PANAS, GDS, BRUMS and others), with automatic scoring and results visualization.
- Co-supervised undergraduate theses related to the framework: an AI assistant that recommends evaluation methods (EVA), a micro-frontend architecture and a tool that supports heuristic evaluation.

Master's researcher · ICMC-USP 2020 – 2022

EmoFrame: bringing emotional response assessment instruments from paper to digital · CAPES scholarship

- Carried out a systematic mapping of emotional assessment instruments, published at HCII 2022.
- Used participatory design and evolutionary prototyping with Psychology and Gerontology professionals.
- Moderated a usability test with 11 participants and cross-checked SUS results with interviews and a heuristic evaluation by 3 HCI experts.

Other user studies 2023 – 2026

- **ePAGe (IHC 2023):** as first author, compared how experts and non-experts interpret the results of a Gerontology instrument, with 4 professionals analyzing 7 real anonymized results.
- **RUFUS (CHI PLAY 2026):** helped conduct usability tests with educators of children with autism, using think-aloud, Cognitive Barrier Walkthrough, SUS and SAM. Also collected and analyzed the data and volunteered at the partner institution. The study identified 8 friction points, each with an improvement recommendation.
- **Pix and a riverside community (IHC 2023):** analyzed field data from 12 residents of a riverside community in Pará, Brazil, collected through interviews, icon interpretation and prototype testing. The study produced 14 design recommendations.
- **Where Is My Persona? (IHC 2026, Best Paper):** supervised the study and took part in planning and evaluations, comparing GenderMag with the experience of a trans person creating a Reddit account.
- **EVA (IHC 2026):** co-supervised the project, gathered requirements with experts and analyzed the results of the evaluation of an LLM-based assistant with 8 experts.

Outreach scholarship holder · LABVIS, UFPA 2019 – 2020

Undergraduate research scholarship holder · LCBIO, UFPA 2015 – 2019

Bio-inspired Computing · CNPq scholarship

Skills

Exploratory research: semi-structured interviews, surveys, field research, participatory design and requirements gathering.

Experience measures: SUS, UEQ, SAM, PANAS, Likert scales and descriptive analysis.

Synthesis: systematic literature reviews and mappings, and qualitative analysis.

Interface evaluation: moderated tests, think-aloud, heuristic evaluation, cognitive walkthrough and Communicability Evaluation Method.

Inclusive research: older adults and people with disabilities, trans and gender diverse people, GenderMag and screen reader inspection.

Research ethics: Ethics Committee protocols, informed consent and data anonymization.

Education

PhD in Computer Science and Computational Mathematics · ICMC-USP 2022 – present
Advisor: Kamila Rios da Hora Rodrigues · Co-advisor: Marcelle Pereira Mota

Master's in Computer Science and Computational Mathematics · ICMC-USP 2020 – 2022
Advisor: Kamila Rios da Hora Rodrigues
Dissertation: EmoFrame: a framework of assessments of users' emotional responses to interactive systems (in Portuguese).
doi.org/10.11606/D.55.2022.tde-18112022-142521

Bachelor's in Computer Engineering · UFPA 2014 – 2020

Awards

- Best Paper, Innovative Ideas and Emerging Results Track, IHC 2026
- Best Paper, WASHES 2024 (co-author)
- Best Project, WebMedia LF Award 2024 (co-author)
- Honorable Mention, Full Papers Track, IHC 2019 (co-author)

Selected publications

- Santos, S. S. et al. Rethinking HCI Evaluation Through a Multimodal Framework. IHC 2026. Presented in October 2026; proceedings forthcoming.
- Amorim, I. L. B.; Santos, S. S. et al. Where Is My Persona? Trans and Gender Diverse Perspectives on the Limits of Persona-Based Evaluation in HCI. IHC 2026. Best Paper; proceedings forthcoming.
- Carhuaz, K. F. M.; Santos, S. S.; Rodrigues, K. R. H. Fostering Computational Thinking in Children with ASD: A Tailored Digital Game Design Proposal. CHI PLAY Companion 2026. doi.org/10.1145/3800965.3834326
- Santos, S. S. et al. Analyzing the Results of a Gerontology Data Collection Instrument: How do Specialists and Non-specialists Interpret the Data? IHC 2023. doi.org/10.1145/3638067.3638096
- Teran, L. A. et al. A Case Study with a Riverside Community to Improve Apps Instant Payments Access. IHC 2023. doi.org/10.1145/3638067.3638090
- Santos, S. S.; Rodrigues, K. R. H. A Systematic Mapping Study of Emotional Response Evaluation Instruments. HCI International 2022.
- Santos, S. S.; Campos, E. M.; Rodrigues, K. R. H. EmoFrame: Prototype of a Framework to Assess Users' Emotional Responses. HCI International 2022.

IHC is the Brazilian Symposium on Human Factors in Computing Systems. Full list on Google Scholar (26 works).

Supervision

Co-supervised 5 undergraduate theses at UFPA (2022–2026) on AI-based method recommendation, HCI framework architecture, heuristic evaluation, systems for Gerontology and gender in HCI.

Other activities

- Outreach in digital education for older adults (ICMC-USP)
- Organizing committee of IHC 2021 and IHC 2022
- Languages: Portuguese (native) and English (good command of reading, writing, speaking and listening)